# President Trump Pauses Penalties on Russia

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President Donald Trump has paused some **sanctions** on Russia. **Sanctions** are **penalties**, like limits on money and trade. Countries use them to push another country to change what it is doing.

The US **Congress** passed these **sanctions**, and Trump signed them into law in September. They were meant to pressure Russia over its war in Ukraine. They were set to start in just two days.

On Friday night, Trump signed an order to pause some of them. Secretary of State Marco Rubio said the pause will last 60 days. The government wants to study how the **sanctions** could affect the US and world **economy**.

Ukraine's President Volodymyr Zelensky said the **sanctions** "could have helped enormously" to end the war. A Russian **envoy**, Kirill Dmitriev, praised Trump's order.

Lawmakers from both big US parties criticized the pause. Texas Senator Ted Cruz called it a mistake. Texas Senator John Cornyn called it "**reckless**."

## Word Treasure

**sanctions** -- Penalties that limit money or trade to pressure a country.
**penalties** -- Punishments for doing something others think is wrong.
**Congress** -- The part of the US government that makes laws.
**envoy** -- A person sent by a country to speak for it.
**economy** -- How money, jobs and trade work in a place.
**reckless** -- Not careful about what could go wrong.

## Background you need

Russia and Ukraine are at war, and many countries have tried to pressure Russia to stop.

Sanctions are rules that limit trade or money so a country feels pressure without fighting.

In the US, Congress makes laws, and the president is in charge of carrying them out.

## Break it down

**WHO:** President Donald Trump and Secretary of State Marco Rubio
**WHAT:** Trump paused some sanctions on Russia for 60 days
**WHERE:** The United States, with effects on Russia and Ukraine
**WHY:** The government wants to study how the sanctions could affect the US and world economy

## Why it matters

Decisions like this show how countries try to stop a war without fighting.

## Test what you remember

**1. How long will the pause last?**

- (A) 10 days
- (B) One year
- (C) Forever
- (D) 60 days

**2. What are sanctions?**

- (A) Gifts between countries
- (B) New roads
- (C) A kind of army
- (D) Penalties, like limits on money and trade

**3. When did Trump sign the sanctions into law?**

- (A) On Sunday
- (B) In September
- (C) Last year
- (D) In June

**4. Who praised Trump's order?**

- (A) Senator John Cornyn
- (B) Russian envoy Kirill Dmitriev
- (C) President Volodymyr Zelensky
- (D) Senator Ted Cruz

**5. What did Senator John Cornyn call the pause?**

- (A) Reckless
- (B) Wonderful
- (C) Fair
- (D) Funny

**6. Why were the sanctions made?**

- (A) To build schools
- (B) To help Russia sell more goods
- (C) To pressure Russia over its war in Ukraine
- (D) To lower prices in stores

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: D 2: D 3: B 4: B 5: A 6: C

## Questions to think about

1. Ukraine's President Volodymyr Zelensky: Says the sanctions could have helped enormously to end the war.

2. Russian envoy Kirill Dmitriev: Praised Trump's order.

3. Senators Ted Cruz and John Cornyn: Criticized the pause, calling it a mistake and reckless.

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):